
CHAPTER 2 HISTORICAL EVOLUTION OF TONGYUAN WARD

2.1 CRITERIA FOR PERIODIZATION AND OVERVIEW OF HISTORICAL STAGES

For a historically complex and multi-functional area like Tongyuan Ward, periodization is the logical starting point for research. Dividing its history into distinct stages creates a temporal framework that reveals the area's evolution, directly informing heritage conservation and reconstruction.

The history and architectural development of Tongyuan Ward were not a simple linear progression, but deeply connected to the spread of Catholicism and social change in modern China. By examining three key factors—ecclesiastical status, architectural layout, and external societal impacts—this book establishes a clear periodization based on three fundamental changes:

First, **significant Shifts in Religious-Administrative Status**. The establishment of Tongyuan Ward as a general motherhouse (Cathedral), the permanent residence of the bishop, and the eventual relocation of the Cathedral.

Second, **morphological Transformations of the Architectural Complex** (Construction and Fortification). The large-scale construction of churches, the fortification of the settlement through the building of city walls, and the completion of functional auxiliary buildings (such as convents and seminaries).

Finally, **major Impacts of the Eternal Social Environment**. The dismantling of the ban on Catholicism in the late Qing Dynasty, social crises brought about by the Hui Muslim Uprisings and famines, and the chaotic warfare among modern warlords.

2.2 OVERVIEW OF KEY HISTORICAL STAGES

To build a clear and critical historical narrative, this chapter examines three key dimensions: Tongyuan Ward's political and religious status, the physical morphology of its architectural complex, and the influence of external social forces. The historical stages are largely delineated by changes in Tongyuan Ward's administrative standing within the Shaanxi Catholic Diocese. Ultimately, its defining milestones were intrinsically linked to its status as a head church or cathedral.

1) Catholicism in Shaanxi

In the late Ming and early Qing dynasties, Catholicism established its foothold in Shaanxi. Wang Zheng was baptized in 1615 as the province's first Catholic convert. In 1625, he invited the Belgian Jesuit Nicolas Trigault to set up a church in Jingyang County of Shaanxi, marking the formal introduction of Catholicism into Shaanxi. Together, they co-authored *Xiru Ermu Zi* (Aids to the Eyes and Ears of Western Scholars) and established a printing press to promote cultural exchange.

In 1627, Johann Adam Schall von Bell succeeded Trigault and arrived in Xi'an, where he built Chongyi Church in 1638, consolidating the local mission. Álvaro Semedo translated and introduced the Nestorian Stele in Shaanxi, drawing European scholarly attention. Étienne Fabre devoted 24 years to deep evangelization in Hanzhong, Shaanxi, attracting converts through miracles and charitable works. By 1664, the number of Catholics in Shaanxi had reached 60,000, accounting for 40% of the national total and ranking first among all provinces. In 1696, Shaanxi was elevated to an Apostolic Vicariate. The main factors behind this flourishing were the spiritual inspiration of the Nestorian Stele, the region's strategic importance, and the parallel implementation of both **"elite academic evangelization" and "popular miraculous evangelization" strategies**.

The Jesuits in Shaanxi adopted the two-track missionary strategy: the elite academic approach targeted the scholar-official class, using Western sciences (mathematics, astronomy, etc.) as a medium to gain respect, while translating Confucian classics and integrating indigenous concepts to achieve cultural convergence; the popular miraculous approach targeted the common people, responding to their worldly needs through miracles such as "driving away locusts" and "subduing tigers," as well as rituals like sprinkling holy water and prayers, attracting believers through demonstrations of efficacy. The parallel operation of these two strategies satisfied the scholar-officials' desire for new knowledge and the common people's longing for tangible efficacy, enabling Catholicism to take root simultaneously among both the elite and grassroots levels of Shaanxi society.

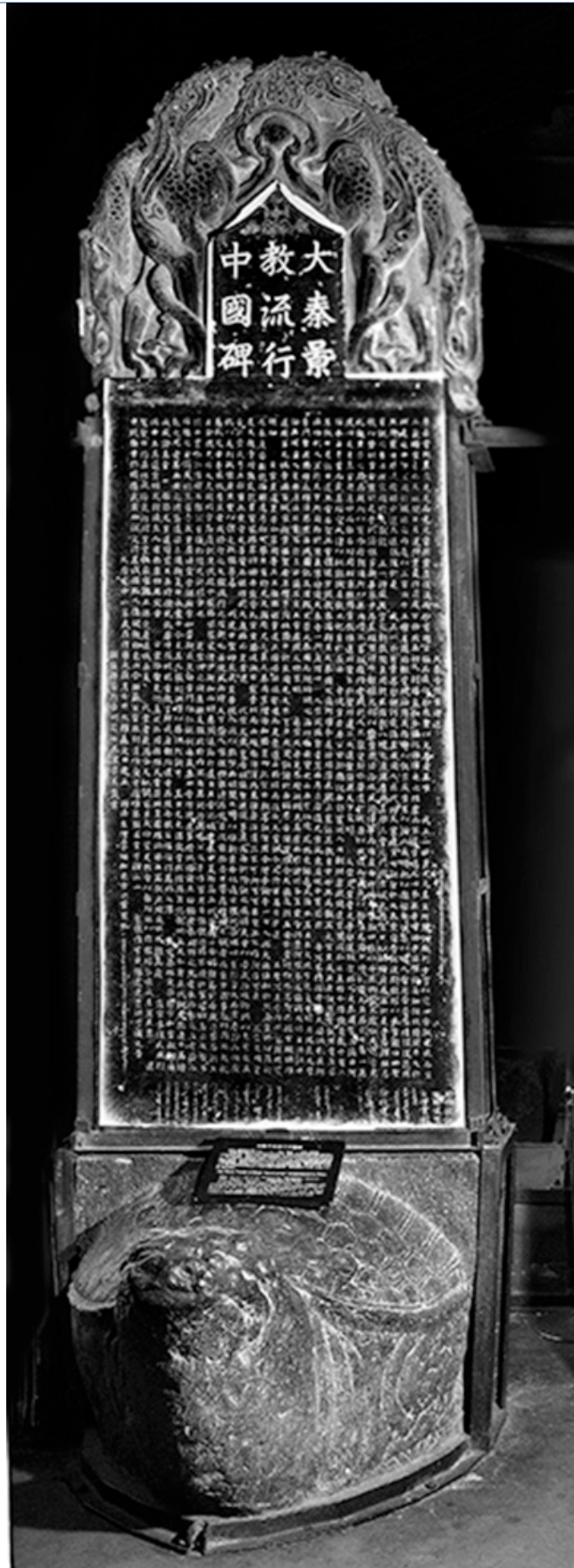


Figure 2-1 The Xi'an Nestorian Stele (In Xi'an Beilin Museum)

Tongyuan Ward in Gaoling was originally known as "Nanliujia" (or Liujiabu), a sparsely populated village in its early days. The area has a deep Catholic history originating in the late Ming dynasty; legend has it that local villager Liu Guangzu and his family converted during this period. In 1668 (the 7th year of the Kangxi era), descendants of Wei Liangdong—a Catholic from Fuping County—relocated to Liujiabu due to financial hardships. Soon after, other Catholic families surnamed Kang moved from Fuping as well, helping to spread Catholicism among local clans including the Lius, Lis, Wangs, Lüs, and Hans. As religious activity flourished, Tongyuan Ward's impact on surrounding communities expanded, drawing a steadily growing number of faithful.

After the Chinese Rites Controversy, the Franciscans secured imperial permits (yinpiao) from the Qing court, assuming leadership of the Shaanxi mission from the Jesuits. The Holy See appointed Basilius Brollo (叶宗贤) as the first Vicar Apostolic in 1696, designating Luqiao Town in Jingyang as the administrative headquarters. The creation of the Tongyuan Ward base reflected the Franciscans' twin goals of consolidation and expansion. With the Opium Wars securing legal access to China's interior for foreign missionaries, Bishop Alfonso Maria di Donato (冯尚仁) chose to bypass the provincial capital of Xi'an—a stronghold of Qing authority ripe for anti-foreign hostility. Instead, he erected the bishop's residence in Tongyuan Ward, a location featuring a strong local parish, geographical seclusion, and easy access to the broader Guanzhong region. This pivotal move transformed Tongyuan Ward from a humble village into the undisputed hub of Catholicism in Northwest China.

2) The Origin of Tongyuan Ward

The establishment of the Tongyuan Ward was the outcome of the Franciscans' dual strategy of consolidation and expansion. Following the Opium Wars, foreign missionaries secured the legal right to preach in the Chinese hinterland through the Treaty of Wanghia signed in 1844. In 1845, Bishop Alfonso Maria di Donato (冯尚仁) bypassed the provincial capital of Xi'an—where Qing governmental control was rigid and anti-foreign sentiment ran high—and instead chose to construct the episcopal residence in Tongyuan Ward, Gaoling County. This location offered a strong Catholic parish base, relative geographic seclusion, and convenient access to the surrounding Guanzhong Plain. From then on, Tongyuan Ward transformed from an ordinary village into the administrative, educational, and spiritual hub of Catholicism in Northwest China.

In fact, the status of Tongyuan Ward as the diocesan center was established as early as the mid-Qing dynasty. During the Kangxi reign, the Italian Franciscan missionary Francesco Saraceni (方启升) arrived in China. In 1716, he traveled to Shaanxi to oversee ecclesiastical affairs in Xi'an and Sanyuan, purchasing land and constructing a seven-bay brick-and-timber church built in a distinctly traditional Chinese architectural style in Tongyuan Ward. As the first resident bishop to administer church affairs across both Shanxi and Shaanxi provinces from Tongyuan Ward, Saraceni(方启升)served here until his death in 1742 and was buried in the village. This initial site

selection established Tongyuan Ward's historic position as the administrative center (head church) of the Shaanxi Diocese. Marking the beginning of this legacy, a total of 12 bishops successively took up residence in Tongyuan Ward over a period spanning more than a century until 1932.

Table 2-1 Key Historical Figures in Tongyuan Ward

Portrait	Name /birth Date	Notes
	利玛窦 Matteo Ricci 1552.10.6-1610.5.11	An Italian Catholic Jesuit missionary A pioneer of Catholic evangelization in China. He adopted a missionary strategy that synthesized Catholic doctrine with Confucian ethical concepts, accepting traditional rites. He maintained that ancestor worship among the Chinese was merely an expression of reverence for forebears—intended to teach descendants to honor their living parents—and carried no religious significance. In his view, ancestor veneration and Confucian rites were purely secular ceremonies of commemoration that did not contradict Catholic doctrine.
	金尼閣 Nicolas Trigault 1577-1628	An Italian Catholic Jesuit missionary He translated Nicolas Trigault's China in the Sixteenth Century: The Journals of Matthew Ricci.
	汤若望 Johann Adam Schall von Bell, 或 Adam Schall 1591.5.1-1666.8.15	A Catholic Jesuit missionary Served in China for 47 years during the late Ming and early Qing dynasties, eventually reaching the rank of first-class official. On June 23, 1622, together with 2 other fellow Jesuits Giovanni Bruno and Giacomo Rho, he commanded gunners to successfully repel the combined Anglo-Dutch fleet invading Macao. In the summer of 1627, he established a small church within the city of Xi'an. He authored Yuanjing Shuo (On the Telescope) in Chinese, introducing Galileo's telescope, and in 1630 assisted Xu Guangqi in compiling the Chongzhen Lishu (Chongzhen Calendar), as well as casting Western-style cannons for the Ming court.
	曾德昭 Alvaro Semedo 1586-1658	A Catholic Jesuit missionary Formerly went by the name Xie Wulu. Having survived the Nanjing Religious Incident of 1616, he authored The History of That Great and Renowned Monarchy of China (Imperio de la China) and translated the Nestorian Stele of the Tang Dynasty (Nestorian Tablet), which aroused widespread attention in the West.

Portrait	Name /birth Date	Notes
	方启升 Francesco Saraceni 1679-1741.12.1	An Italian Franciscan friar He traveled to Shaanxi in 1716 to oversee ecclesiastical affairs in Xi'an and Sanyuan. He first constructed the Xi'an South Church on Wuxing Street, and subsequently purchased wasteland in Tongyuan Ward to erect a church. During a period of anti-Catholic persecution, he took refuge in an earthen cave dwelling on the hillside of Zhanggegou in Yuanqu Village, Weinan.
	叶宗贤 Basilius Brollo 1848.3.25-1704.11.16	An Italian Franciscan friar Arrived in Shaanxi in April 1701 to oversee ecclesiastical affairs. He compiled two Chinese–Latin dictionaries (Dictionarium Sinico-Latinum).
	冯尚仁 Alfonso Maria di Donato 1783-1848.5.20	An Italian Franciscan friar Established a seminary in Tongyuan Ward in 1845 to train seminarians brought from Shanxi. In 1848, he founded a church school to enhance the general education and religious literacy of local Catholics.
	高一志 Ephysius Chiais 1808.2.17-1884.4.12	An Italian Franciscan friar Became the Vicar Apostolic of Shaanxi in 1848, establishing seminaries and schools. During the Hui Muslim Uprising in the first year of the Tongzhi reign (1860), the Apostolic Vicariate of Shaanxi established an orphanage at the Tongyuan Church, taking in infants and children who were orphaned or abandoned due to the war. In 1867, due to failing health that hindered his pastoral duties, he appointed the Italian missionary Pasquale Amato Pagnucci (林爱奇) in Tongyuan Ward, as Coadjutor Bishop to take charge of the Shaanxi Vicariate. In 1875, Bishop Gao and Coadjutor Bishop Lin expanded the original seven-bay cathedral in Tongyuan Ward into a 14-bay brick-and-timber structure blending Chinese and Western architectural styles. During the severe famine of 1878, both bishops launched extensive relief efforts by establishing centers in Tongyuan Ward and other regions to distribute money, grain, and clothing to refugees, opening a charitable hospital to treat the sick, taking in orphans and the elderly, burying victims, and providing seeds to restore agricultural production. They also organized relief-for-work projects to assemble refugees to build the Tongyuan Ward town wall, fostering harmonious relations between the Church and local civil authorities.

Portrait	Name /birth Date	Notes
	林奇爱 Pasquale Amato Pagnucci 1833.10.12-1901.2.1	An Italian Franciscan friar In 1883, he rebuilt both the Xi'an South Church—a 12-bay structure comprising three altar bays, eight nave bays, and one facade bay—and the North Church. In 1880, Coadjutor Bishop Lin constructed a three-story building in Tongyuan Ward to serve as the episcopal residence (bishop's palace). In October 1888, the Tongyuan Relief Hospital was established. In 1890, he invited the Franciscan Missionaries of Mary (FMM) to undertake missionary work in Shaanxi. On December 21, the FMM sisters arrived in Tongyuan Ward, where they took over the Holy Childhood Association (Baochi Hui) and launched social charitable endeavors, including a relief hospital and a home for the aged.
	何理熙 Odorico Giuseppe Rizz 1858.4.28-1905.3.22	An Italian Franciscan friar
	胡定邦 Athanasius Götte 1857.4.11-1908.3.29	A German Franciscan friar Convened the Conference of Bishops from Franciscan Mission Dioceses in China at Tongyuan Ward in 1908.
	穆理思 Auguste Jean Gabriel Maurice 1862.10.10-1925.7.27	A French Franciscan friar Established an agency postal and telegraph office in Tongyuan Ward in 1913 to facilitate local communications.
	希贤 Eugenio Massi 1875.8.13-1944.12.10	An Italian Franciscan friar In 1916, amidst warlord infighting and frequent anti-Christian unrest, Bishop Goette coordinated with various factions to safeguard the Tongyuan Ward Cathedral from the ravages of war, providing refuge for up to 10,000 displaced people. In November 1927, a night vigil prayer and a torchlight procession deterred the local garrison stationed in Gaoling from launching a planned night raid on Tongyuan Ward.

Portrait	Name /birth Date	Notes
	戴夏德 Fiorenz Umberto Tessitore 1892.4.27-1932.4.10	An Italian Franciscan friar Well-versed in physics, mechanics, and particularly electricity, he installed an automatic generator and a seismograph at the Tongyuan Ward Seminary to monitor seismic activity. In 1920, he constructed a meteorological observatory to forecast weather changes. Deeply appreciative of Chinese culture, he brought three artifacts to Pope Pius XI's 192 Vatican Exhibition, which he had purchased in 1917 from Wang Guo, a tenth-generation descendant of Wang Zheng: two Ming-dynasty Catholic manuscripts—one in Latin and one in Syriac—along with a chalice. In 1927, he relocated the episcopal residence from Tongyuan Ward, Gaoling, to the Xi'an South Church.
	班锡宜 Fulgenzio Pasini 1897.4.2-1985.4.17	An Italian Franciscan friar

3) Eating and Relying on the Church: Catholic Expansion Amid War and Famine

Tongyuan Ward's rise was deeply linked to three key social shifts in modern Shaanxi—making the settlement a clear microcosm of the region's broader history.

The first occurred during the **Muslim Rebellion of 1862**. As the flames of war raged for two years, the Guanzhong Plain was reduced to absolute ruin. According to *A History of the Population of China, Vol. 5: The Qing Period*, Shaanxi Province—which originally boasted a total population of over 13 million—suffered a staggering 4.66 million casualties. Yet amid this catastrophe, Catholic villages escaped severe destruction, largely thanks to a pivotal figure: Bishop Ephrem Giamarchi (高一志). Well before the outbreak of hostilities, he had already constructed a fortified defense system. Furthermore, he personally ventured into the rebel camps to negotiate, successfully securing a pledge that Catholics would be spared. In an era of despair, this offered local residents a beacon of hope for survival, transforming Tongyuan Ward into a safe haven for Han refugees seeking asylum during the chaotic times. Many among them chose to receive baptism simply to save their lives—a phenomenon known as "converting for sustenance/protection" (kao jiao). Consequently, Tongyuan Ward underwent a profound shift in its demographic structure and community character: it rapidly evolved from a solitary village church into a massive, integrated religious community blending ecclesiastical and secular life, marking a monumental milestone in the history of Catholicism's spread in late-Qing Shaanxi.

From the 1st to the 4th year of the Guangxu reign (1875–1878), the catastrophic "**Ding-Wu Famine**" (Dingwu Qihuang) ravaged North China, dealing a devastating blow to Shaanxi

Province, particularly the Guanzhong Plain. Historical records describe a vast expanse of "parched, barren land" strewn with corpses of the starved. The disaster in the Weibei region was especially tragic. According to the Gazetteer of Tongzhou Prefecture (Tongzhou Fu Zhi), during the winter of the 3rd year of Guangxu (1877), "the cold was extreme, and many people froze to death." Similarly, a stela inscribed with the Song of Famine (Huang Sui Ge), preserved in the Xi'an Beilin Museum, vividly documents the plight of Hancheng: "In the 3rd year of Guangxu, a severe drought struck... springs dried up, rivers shrank, and well bottoms turned bone-dry." Desperate civilians stripped elm bark and chewed grass roots to survive; horrors even reached the extent of "fathers and sons consuming one another," laying bare an unparalleled human tragedy. The translation of the Song of Famine (Huang Sui Ge) is as follows:

In the third year of Guangxu, a massive drought spread wide.

Shanxi, Shaanxi, and Henan suffered, but our Hancheng was hit worst of all.

The heavens last dropped sweet rain back in the eighth month of the previous year.

The drought was so severe that springs failed, rivers shrank, and the bottoms of wells dried up.

The color of the sky changed drastically; panic gripped the people's hearts.

Everywhere, people prayed for rain; everyone cried out to the heavens.

All goods became dirt cheap, while grain became worth a fortune.

The strong and able-bodied fled in starvation, while the crops withered and dried, leaving people in agonizing torment.

By the seventh month, bandits gathered in Xichuan.

From tens to hundreds, from hundreds to thousands.

Suozi stationed his troops at Wujiao Mountain, starting his uprising at Baimatan.

Our county was governed by Magistrate Wang, who was truly a man of conscience.

He refused to recruit local militia just to spare the people's money, but who could have foreseen that the bandits would ravage the Southern Plains?

Men and women fled the famine to castles and walled villages, their bellies aching with hunger, finding no peace.

A dou of rice cost five strings of cash; wheat sold for four strings and two hundred.

Elm bark and thistle-root flour still sold for dozens of cash a scoop.

Wild goose droppings were hard to swallow, yet out of desperation, people had to close their eyes and choke them down.

White clay from the mountains was called "divine flour," and tens of thousands died from eating it.

Brothers with no food could no longer share hardships; husbands and wives with no flour became bitter enemies.

When the old and young met, they had nothing else to talk about; they only spoke of their starvation.

The hunger was extreme, truly unbearable; light-headed and heavy-footed, once you tripped and fell, you became food for others.

To be eaten by strangers was bad enough, but fathers and sons eating each other was too heartbreaking to witness.

In the midst of this devastating famine, the Franciscans tapped into relief funds collected abroad to launch a fort-building project in Tongyuan Ward. By employing starving refugees under a work-for-relief program, the Church built miles of formidable defensive walls, while asking those who received grain to swear an oath to join the faith. This phenomenon—often termed "converting for bread" (chi jiao)—was driven by raw survival rather than pure religious devotion. Yet, it dramatically broadened the reach of Catholicism in Shaanxi, as the province's Catholic population skyrocketed from 13,000 in 1845 to 25,000 by 1878. Through this, Tongyuan Ward achieved its second major milestone, evolving from a simple village parish into a bustling, large-scale religious community.

In 1900 (the 26th year of Guangxu), the dual storm of **the Boxer Movement and the anti-Christian persecution** broke out. Tongyuan Ward (then part of Gaoling County) was hit first and hardest, as it served as the heart of Shaanxi's Catholic administration, the episcopal seat, and the home of the Immaculate Heart of Mary Seminary. Inside the complex, the resident bishop and clergy were joined by thousands of desperate Catholic refugees from nearby towns, as well as the seminary's teachers and students. Tongyuan Ward quickly shifted to a wartime defensive footing. Local Catholics were mobilized to gather their own rations and weapons, relying on their previously built network of massive walls and earthen forts to form a stronghold. Though faced with scarce supplies and relentless siege pressures, Tongyuan Ward successfully drove back repeated, violent assaults, becoming one of the rare Catholic sanctuaries in Shaanxi to hold out undefeated through the turmoil of 1900, ultimately preserving thousands of human lives.

This defense won Tongyuan Ward the legendary reputation of "Catholic Fortress of the Northwest." After the Boxer Protocol was signed in 1901, the diocese rapidly launched reconstruction efforts from its base in Tongyuan Ward. Supported by Boxer Indemnity funds, it went on to expand the convent, the grand seminary, and its affiliated medical facilities. These efforts of renewal and growth firmly established Tongyuan Ward as the central hub of Catholic administration throughout the region.

碑文记述公元1877-1878关中东部大旱
有人相食之惨状及官民救灾赈济等内容

荒岁歌碑

西安碑林博物馆藏 清光绪五年

荒岁歌

光緒三年夏旱甚寬山陝河南惟韓尤
霖雨先年八月間直旱得泉枯河壟
邑大變人心不安處家禱雨人人呼
是賊糧食大值錢壯者亂餓逃外
是匪值至七月間土匪聚西州十
鎮子七兵五角山起手先從白馬
王知縣他本善那良心官不招鄉
料正匪掠南原男女逃避城堡寒
安然年米錢五串麥賣四串三榆
一肋還賣數十錢大雁難十咽
眼餐山白土神起人民吃死有
在土是夫妻無麵結饑死老幼

Figure 2-2 Song of the Year of Famine (a stone tablet preserved in the Xi'an Beilin Museum)

2.3 PERIODIZATION OF HISTORICAL ERAS

As previously discussed, the historical evolution of Tongyuan Ward is the product of a dynamic interplay among modern China's social transformation, the global expansion strategy of the Catholic Church, and local crisis responses. It expanded from a covert missionary outpost (a single "point") into a regional hub for Northwest China (a broader "surface"), before ultimately settling back into a functional monastery (a spatial "dimension"). The underlying logic of its development lies in the Church's keen perception and strategic exploitation of external societal "momentum" (shi): **leveraging unequal treaties to gain political footholds (political momentum); utilizing relief activities during times of famine and turmoil to absorb believers (social momentum); and achieving the fortification of physical space through large-scale construction (material momentum).** Each turning point across these historical stages marks a fundamental shift in the Church's strategy for survival and development, thereby tightly intertwining the fate of Tongyuan Ward with the pulse of modern Chinese history.

Table 2-2: Historical Evolution of Tongyuan Ward (1716–1952)-Phase I

Historical Phase	Core Characteristics	Key Events and Major Figures
Phase I 1711–1845	Initial Roots and Headquarters Designation. After secret development through the Qing religious prohibition, Tongyuan was officially confirmed as the regional administrative hub following the policy deregulation.	Francesco Saraceni(方启升): In 1716, purchased land and built a church, marking the official beginning of the Catholic mission in the Gaoling area and laying its foundational groundwork. 1844: The Qing government relaxed its prohibition policy on Christianity. Alfonso Maria di Donato(冯尚仁): Was formally appointed as Bishop of Shaanxi, selected Tongyuan Ward as the seat of the Shaanxi Vicariate in 1845, and established a male seminary, ushering in a new phase of missionary work in Northwest China. Church schools were first established in 1848.

Table 2-3: Historical Evolution of Tongyuan Ward (1716 – 1952)-Phase II

Historical Phase	Core Characteristics	Key Events and Major Figures
Phase II 1845–1901	Rapid Expansion, Fortification, and Crisis Response. Leveraging social crises such as the Hui Muslim Revolts and widespread famines, the Church rapidly expanded its congregation—a phenomenon often characterized by "converting for bread" (chi jiao) or "relying on the Church for survival" (kao jiao). Through large-scale building and fortification activities, it developed the spatial morphology of a militarized religious hub known as the "Little Rome of the East." By the time Bishop Amato Pagnani (林爱奇)	Ephysius Chiaais (高一志): The longest-serving bishop. During the Hui Muslim Uprising in the first year of the Tongzhi reign (1860), Tongyuan remained safe and unharmed, leading to a surge in the number of believers. Meanwhile, the Apostolic Vicariate of Shaanxi established an orphanage at the Tongyuan Church, taking in infants and children left orphaned or abandoned due to the war. During the Incredible Famine of the Guangxu Era (Ding-Wu Qi Huang, 1875), he provided relief and implemented a work-for-relief program to construct the Tongyuan city walls. In 1875, Bishop Ephysius Chiaais (高一志), and his coadjutor, Amato Pagnani (林爱奇), expanded the original 7-bay cathedral in Tongyuan Ward, Gaoling, into a 14-bay cathedral featuring a hybrid Sino-Western brick-and-timber structure. They introduced the Franciscan Missionaries of Mary sisters and perfected functional infrastructure such as the Holy Childhood Association (Sainte Enfance) and

Historical Phase	Core Characteristics	Key Events and Major Figures
	passed away in 1901, Tongyuan Ward was described as a settlement with "soaring church spires and surrounding city walls."	hospitals. During the 1875 famine, Bishop Ephysius Chiais (高一志) and Coadjutor Amato Pagnani (林爱奇) established relief stations to distribute money, grain, and clothing to refugees. They founded a charitable hospital to treat the sick, adopted the elderly and orphans, buried those who died of starvation, and provided seeds to famine victims. Through a work-for-relief initiative, they mobilized refugees to construct the defensive city walls of Tongyuan Ward. In 1880, Coadjutor Bishop Pagnani(林爱奇) constructed a three-story building in Tongyuan Ward to serve as the Bishop's Palace (Episcopal Residence). In October 1888, the Tongyuan Relief Hospital was established.

Table 2-4: Historical Evolution of Tongyuan Ward (1716 – 1952)-Phase III

Historical Phase	Core Characteristics	Key Events and Major Figures
Phase III 1901–1932	The overt emergence of clerical power struggles and the relocation of the administrative center. As external conflicts temporarily eased, internal power struggles intensified among clergy of different nationalities within the Church. Nevertheless, the Church's functions continued to diversify, serving as a sanctuary during warlord infighting. Ultimately, its status as the primary administrative center was transferred elsewhere.	The Era of Odorico Giuseppe Rizz(何理熙)、Athanasius Götte(胡定邦)、Auguste Jean Gabriel Maurice(穆理思): Beginning in 1902, internal clerical power struggles came to the fore, with escalating infighting and factional rivalry among German, French, and Spanish friars. In 1908, Bishop Athanasius Goette (胡定邦) convened the Synod of Franciscan Bishops in China at Tongyuan Ward, attended by eight Franciscan bishops from various northern provinces. In 1913, Bishop Eugenio Massi (穆理思) established a postal and telegraph agency in Tongyuan Ward. Eugenio Massi(希贤): In 1916, amid warlord conflicts, when Liu Zhenhua besieged the city, Tongyuan Ward served as a sanctuary for tens of thousands of refugees. Fiorenz Umberto Tessiatore(戴夏德): Highly proficient in physics and mechanics—particularly electromagnetism—he installed an automated generator and a seismograph in Tongyuan Ward to monitor seismic activity. In 1920, he built a meteorological observatory to forecast weather changes. During the Great Northwest Famine of 1928 (the "Year 18 Famine"), he contacted the China International Famine Relief Commission (CIFRC), securing \$400,000 in funding along with technical support to assist Li Yizhi in restoring the Jinghui Canal (the ancient Zhengguo Canal). In 1932, he officially transferred the cathedral's administrative seat to the South Church in Xi'an. As the Vatican divided the Guanzhong Diocese, Tongyuan Ward's history as an administrative center came to an end, transitioning into an era as a functional monastery.

Table 2-5: Historical Evolution of Tongyuan Ward (1716 – 1952)-Phase IV

Historical Phase	Core Characteristics	Key Events and Major Figures
Phase IV 1933—1950'S	The Era of the Functional Monastery and Indigenous Transformation. Relegated to a monastery under the Diocese of Sanyuan, the site witnessed rising Chinese nationalism and escalating Sino-foreign tensions. This period ultimately culminated in the expulsion of foreign clergy and the completion of the Church's indigenous transformation.	Fulgenzio Pasini(班锡宜):Appointed Apostolic Prefect of Sanyuan in 1932. His marginalization of Chinese personnel sparked repeated protest movements among seminary students, bringing internal tensions to a boiling point. In 1952, foreign clergy were expelled from China.
